Off-street parking on rue de Terrebonne

What the 1954–55 fire-insurance plans, today's aerial imagery and the City's LiDAR show, building by building

Terrebonne-open-sources (a resident of Côte-des-Neiges–Notre-Dame-de-Grâce)

2026-10-25

Source: Underwriters' Survey Bureau, Insurance plan of the city of Montreal, vol. 7, 1954–55 (BAnQ, notice 0000174390). Reading: the author, one row per building. Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0.

60 % of the buildings on Terrebonne were built with a garage

- 126 residential buildings with a Terrebonne address, west end of the lane to Girouard, on the sixteen 1954–55 sheets available
- 75 were built with a garage (north side 57 of 90, south side 18 of 36)
- By dwellings (City roll): 168 of 289, 58 %
- The plans mark garages, not driveways: a lower bound for “garage or driveway as built”



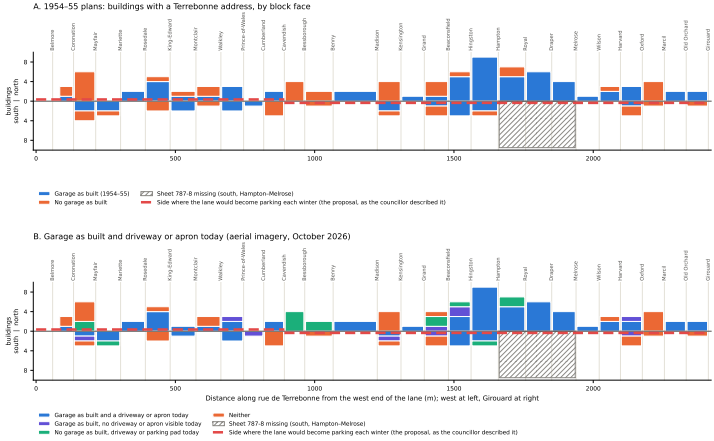
Source: Underwriters' Survey Bureau, Insurance plan of the city of Montreal, vol. 7, 1954–55 (BAnQ, notice 0000174390). Reading: the author, one row per building.

Today, 72 % have a garage as built or a visible driveway

- 123 buildings checked on the Québec government's aerial imagery (leaf-off, 8 cm per pixel, after June 2024)
- 79 show a driveway, paved apron or parking pad today (64 %)
- Garage as built *or* driveway today: 89 of 123 (72 %); by dwellings 70 %
- Of the 1954 garages, 64 keep a visible apron, 10 do not; 15 houses without a garage in 1954 have a driveway today
- What a garage holds inside cannot be seen from above

Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0. Base: Ville de Montréal open data, CC-BY 4.0 (géobase, assessment roll). Reading: the author.

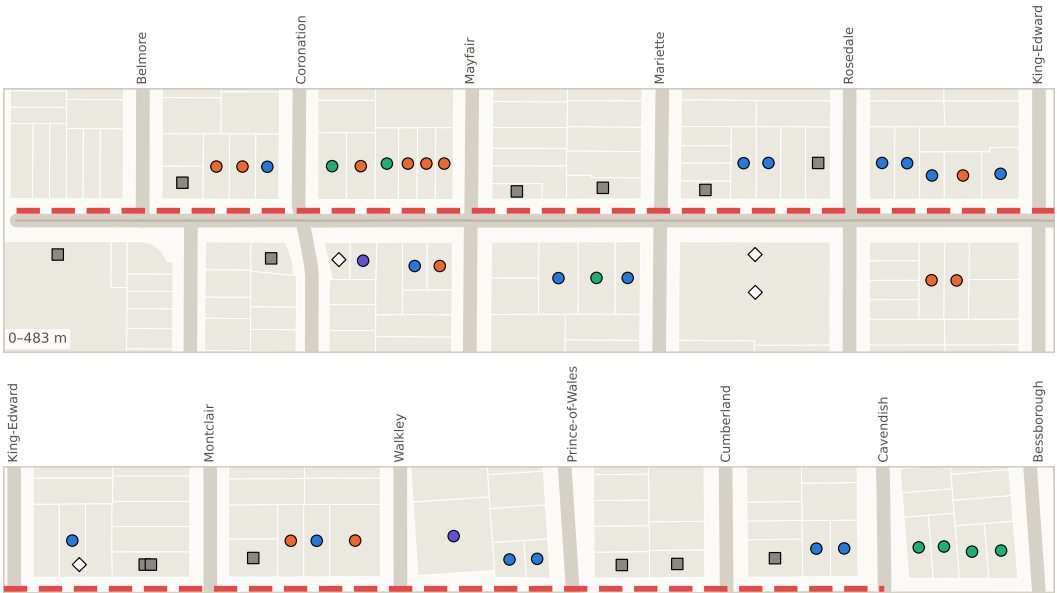
Where the garages and driveways are, along the whole street



Dashed red: the side where the lane would become parking each winter under the proposal, as the councillor described it.

Source: Underwriters' Survey Bureau, Insurance plan of the city of Montreal, vol. 7, 1954–55 (BAnQ, notice 0000174390). Reading: the author, one

On today's parcels: garage as built and driveway today



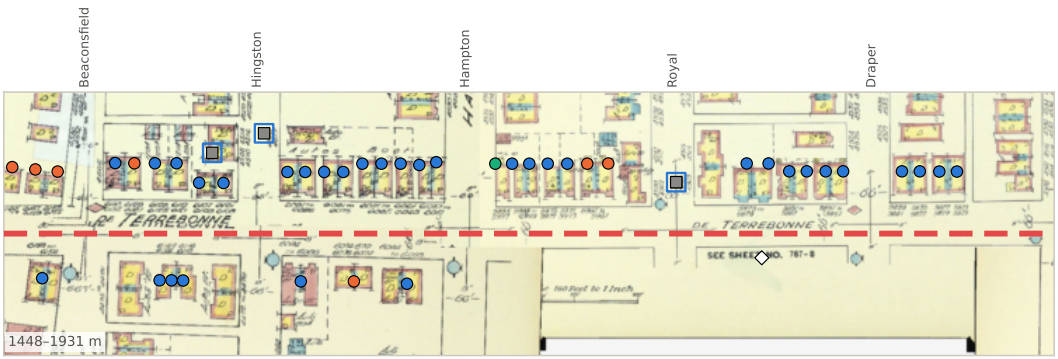
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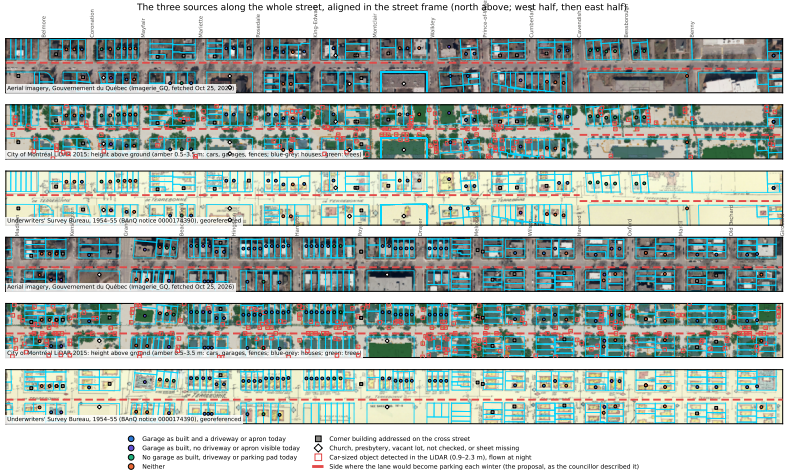
The 1954–55 plans, georeferenced: every garage is written “Auto”



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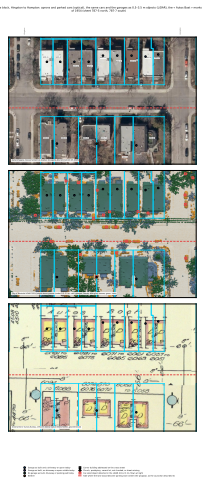
Three sources, one frame



Aerial imagery (optical), the City's 2015 LiDAR as height above ground, and the 1954–55 sheets, all georeferenced into the same street frame.

Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0. Source: Underwriters'

One block in the three sources: Hingston to Hampton

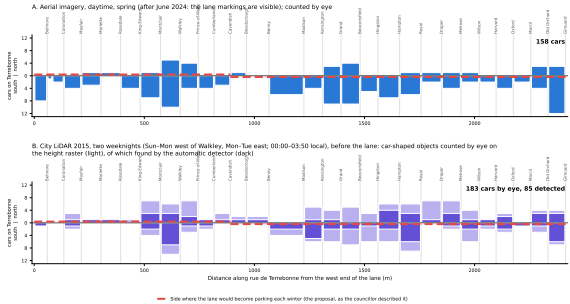


Aprons and parked cars (optical); the same cars and the garages as 0.5–3.5 m objects (LiDAR, red squares = automatic car detections); the “Autos Bast” of 1954.

Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0. Source: Underwriters' Survey Bureau, Insurance plan of the city of Montreal, vol. 7, 1954–55 (BAnQ, notice 0000174390). Reading: the author, one row per building.

Cars parked on the street: two acquisitions, two moments

- Daytime, spring, after June 2024 (aerial imagery): 158 cars on Terrebonne (north 30, south 128)
- Two weeknights, 2015, before the lane (City LiDAR, Sun–Mon and Mon–Tue, 00:00–03:50): 183 cars on Terrebonne by eye (north 93, south 90); an automatic detector finds 85, plus 253 car-sized objects on private lots within 45 m and 70 on the cross streets
- Ten years and a redesign apart: each describes its moment, not a before-and-after



Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0.

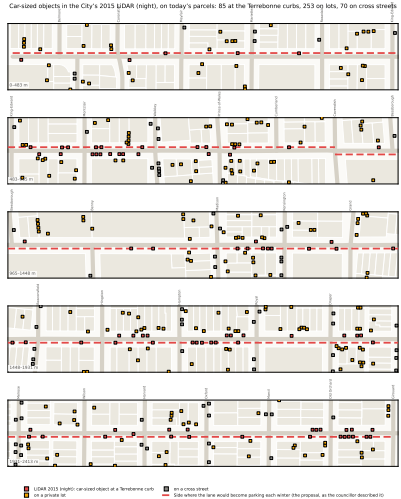
Where the cars were: both acquisitions, panel by panel



Daytime image (by-eye count per block, north | south) above the 2015 night height raster; squares = the detector's cars (red at a Terrebonne curb, orange on a lot, grey on a cross street).

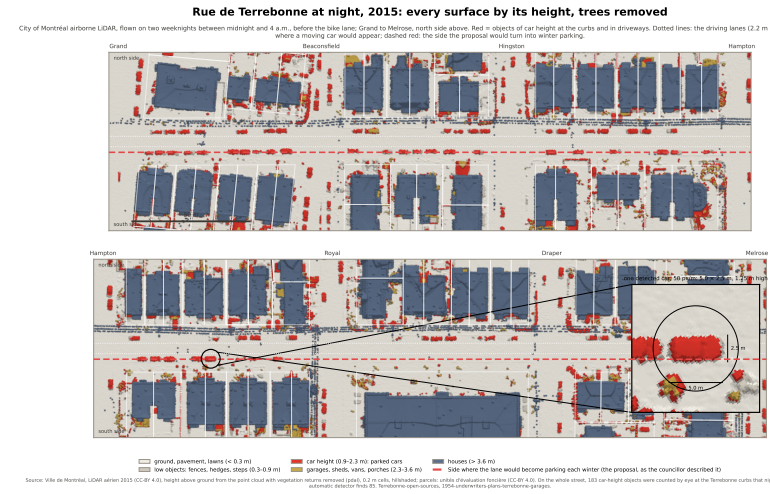
Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_QO, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0.

Every car-sized object the night LiDAR detector found, on today's parcels



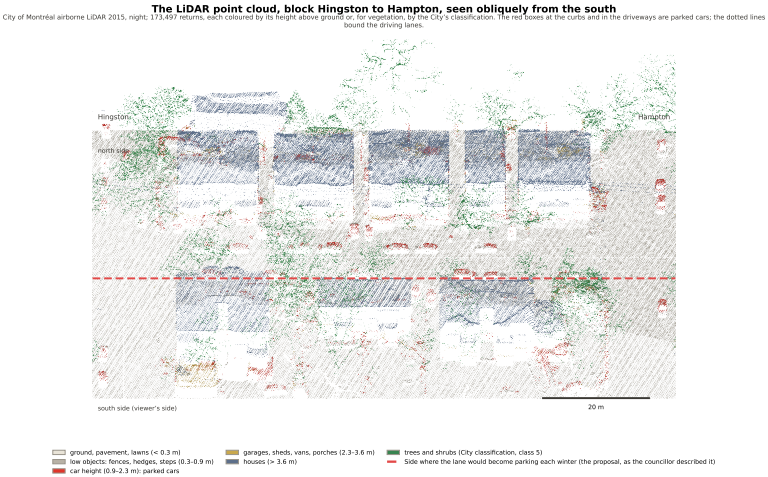
Imagery: Gouvernement du Québec (Imagerie_GQ, fetched Oct. 25, 2026). LiDAR: Ville de Montréal 2015, CC-BY 4.0.

Rue de Terrebonne at night, 2015: every surface by its height, trees removed



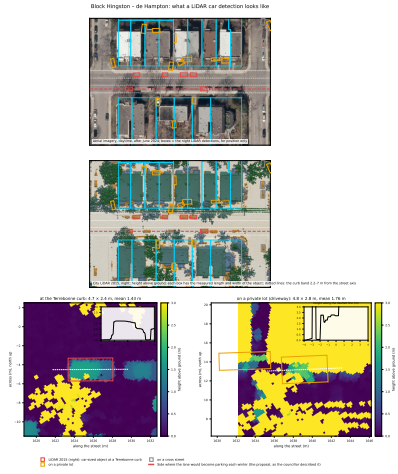
Grand to Melrose; red = car height at the curbs and in the driveways; dotted lines = the driving lanes, where a

The LiDAR point cloud itself, one block, seen obliquely



Every return coloured by its height above ground (car height in red) or, for vegetation, by the City's class: the cars at the curbs and in the driveways, the garage ramps and the sheds are all resolved.

What a LiDAR car detection looks like



Each box has the object's measured length and width; dotted lines bound the curb band (2.2–7 m from the axis) that separates street from lot. Below: a car at the curb and one in a driveway at 40 px/m, with the height in metres; a flat top at 1.4–1.5 m over about 4.5 m.

Checks on the method

- Georeferencing: each sheet fitted on its intersections, residuals under 3.3 m on 14 of 16 sheets (7 m at one point); checked against the City's parcels on every sheet
- The 1954–55 reading agrees with the author's independent June 2024 marks on all 126 buildings
- The present-day reading: one reader, graded row by row, re-readable from public imagery; made before the conversion side was drawn
- LiDAR car detector checked by eye on all 29 blocks: 85 of 183 car-shaped objects found at the curbs (46 %); the by-eye count is the one reported
- A census of the frontage, not a sample; every number scripted from public inputs

Caveats

- Garages as built, not driveways: the 1954–55 share is a lower bound
- As built, as visible: neither reading sees inside a garage (workshop, storage, living space); a 1930 garage may be too small for today's vehicles
- Buildings, not households: a duplex pair has two to four flats and one or two garages
- One sheet missing in 1954–55 (south side, Hampton to Melrose); readings graded medium or unclear are flagged row by row
- Everything is in the table: one row per building, checkable by address

Where to find it

- Web page, note, maps, tables:
  `https://openmobilitydata.github.io/Terrebonne-open-sources/1954-underwriters-plans-terrebonne-garages/`
- The sheets themselves: BAnQ numérique,
  `https://collections.banq.qc.ca/ark:/52327/2244199`
- Repository:
  `https://github.com/OpenMobilityData/Terrebonne-open-sources`

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